

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

Key findings on employment patterns, salary by role and language, and workplace preferences from 65,000+ developers surveyed in 2024.

65,437

respondents

180+

countries

84%

currently working

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global employment breakdown and U.S. full-time change

69%

full-time globally

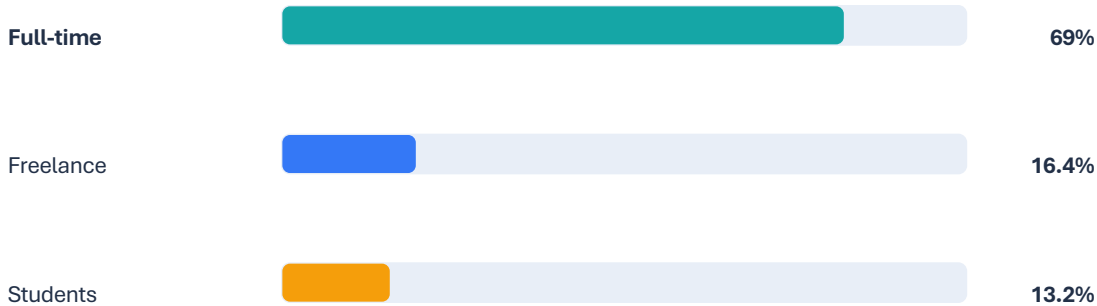
16.4%

freelance / contracting

13.2%

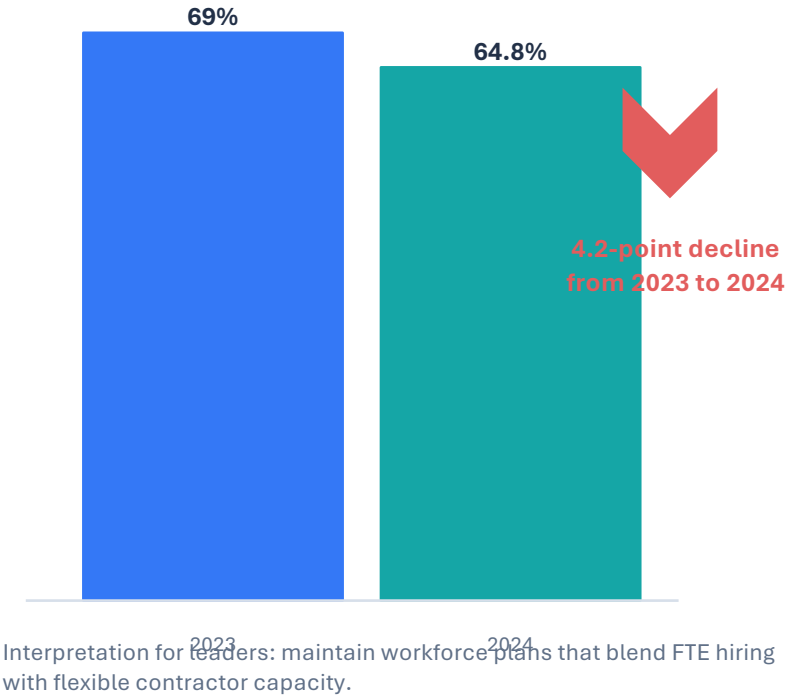
full-time students

Global employment status



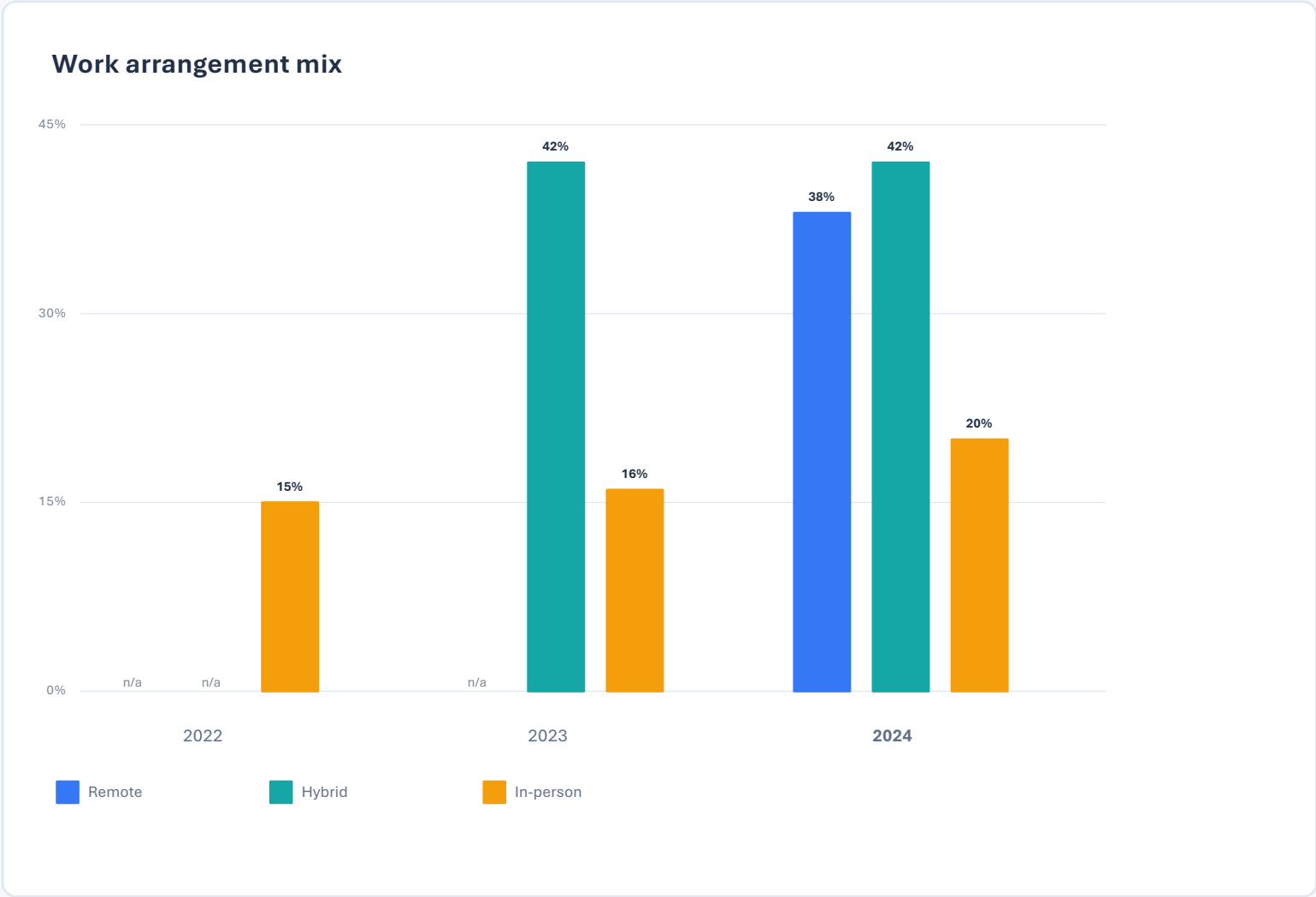
84% currently working
(full-time, part-time, or
freelancing)

U.S. full-time employment



In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Three-year work environment trend, 2022–2024



Signal for workforce policy

42%
hybrid, steady vs.
2023

38%
remote in 2024

In-person work rose from 15% in 2022 to 16% in 2023 and 20% in 2024 — a third consecutive increase.

Retention implication: hybrid remains the modal arrangement even as office attendance edges upward.

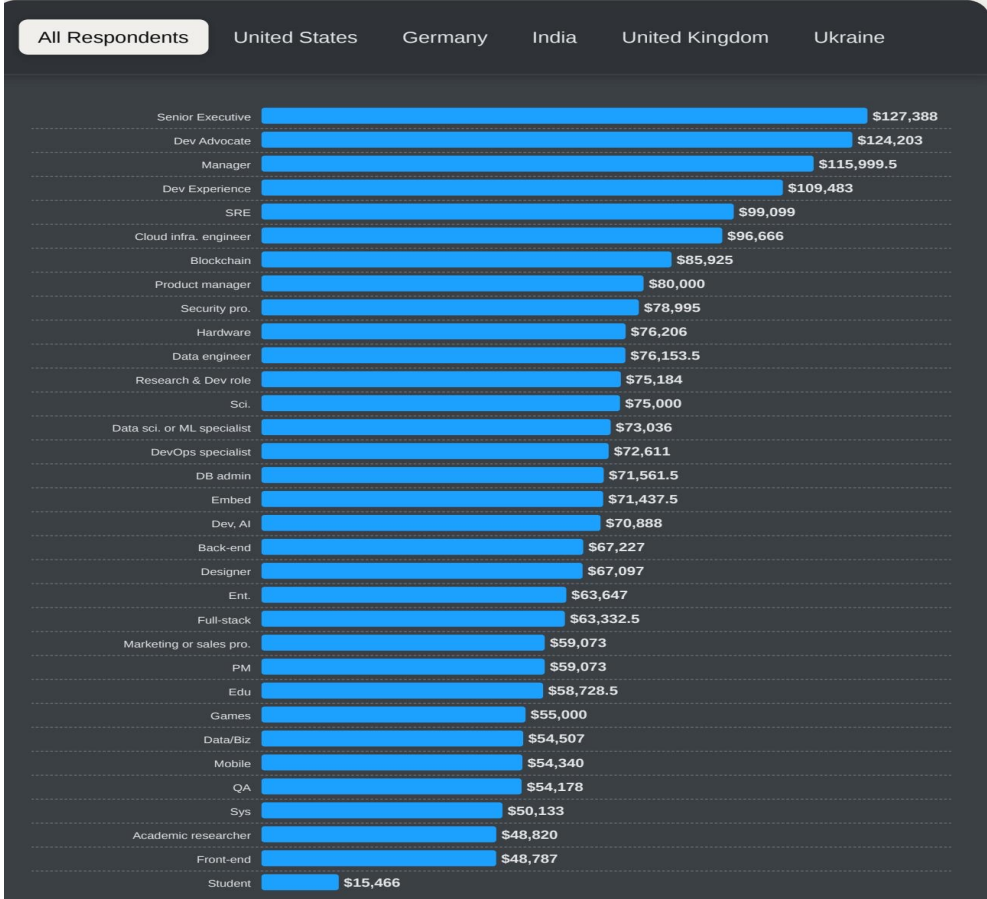
Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Median annual compensation by developer type; top 10 roles from salary responses

Top 10 developer roles by median salary



22,677 salary responses; 34.7% response rate

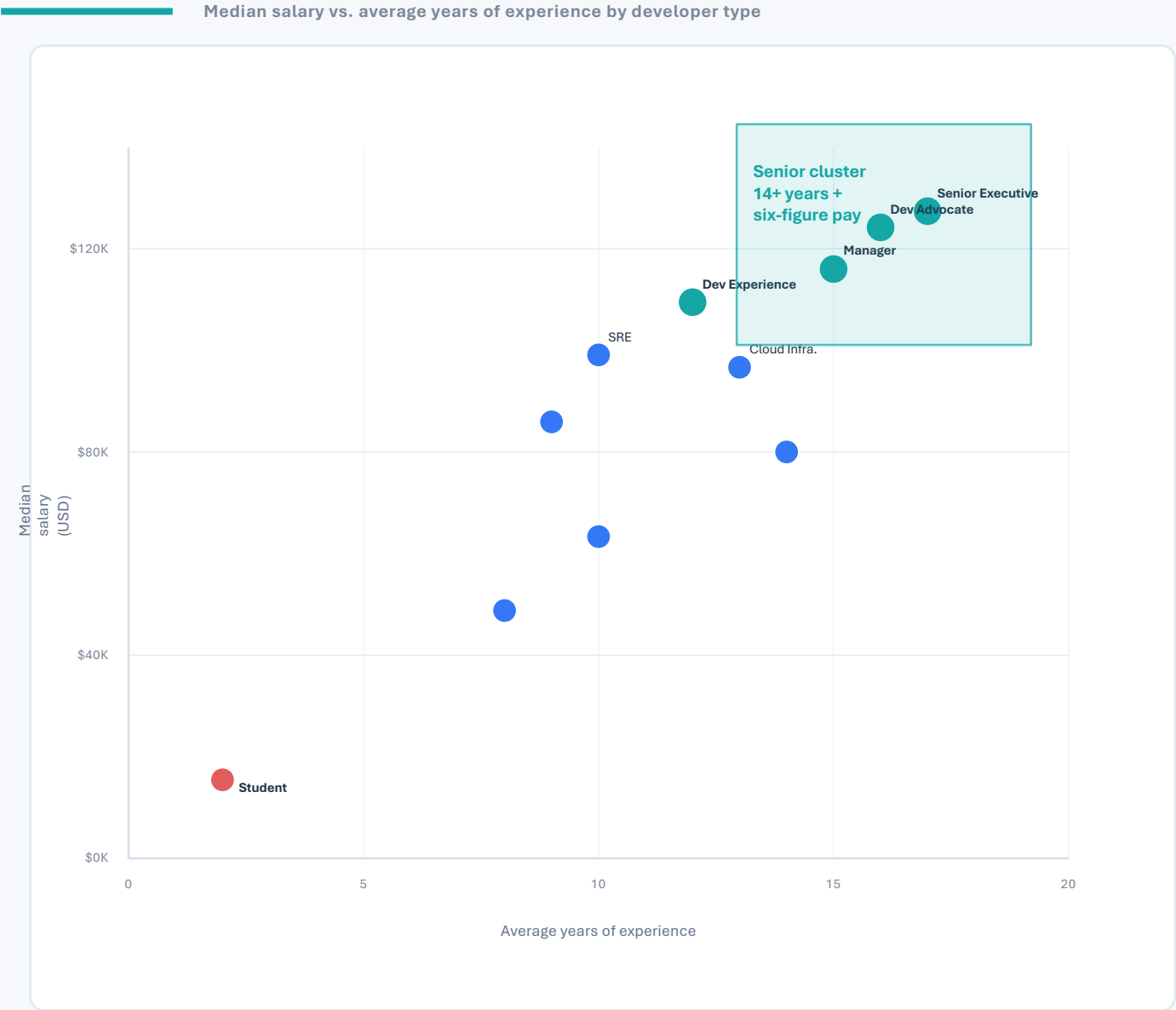


Reference image: figure_1.jpg — salary by developer type

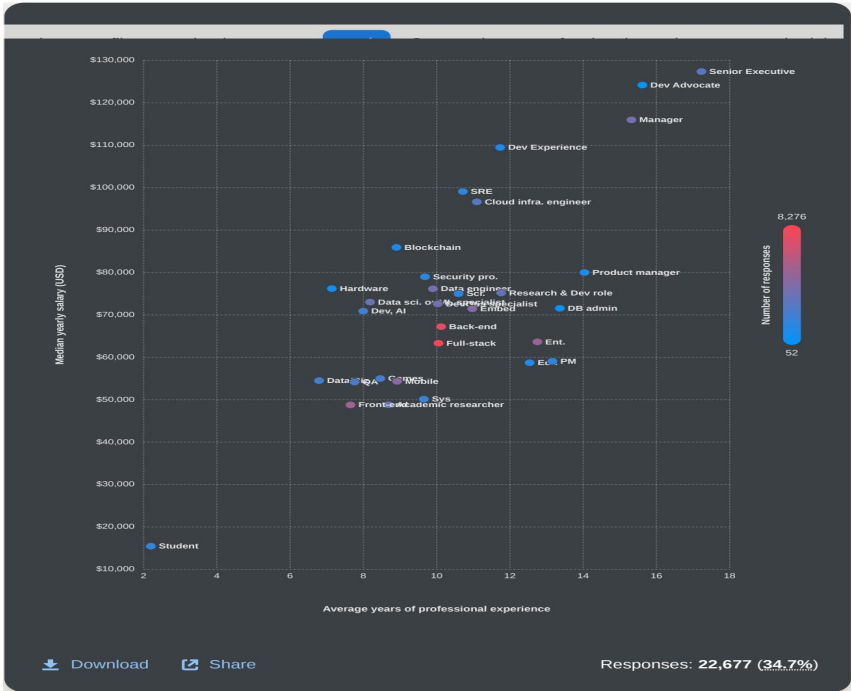
Purely technical premium

SRE (\$99K) and Cloud Infrastructure Engineer (\$97K) lead purely technical roles, reflecting operational criticality.

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024 — Work section

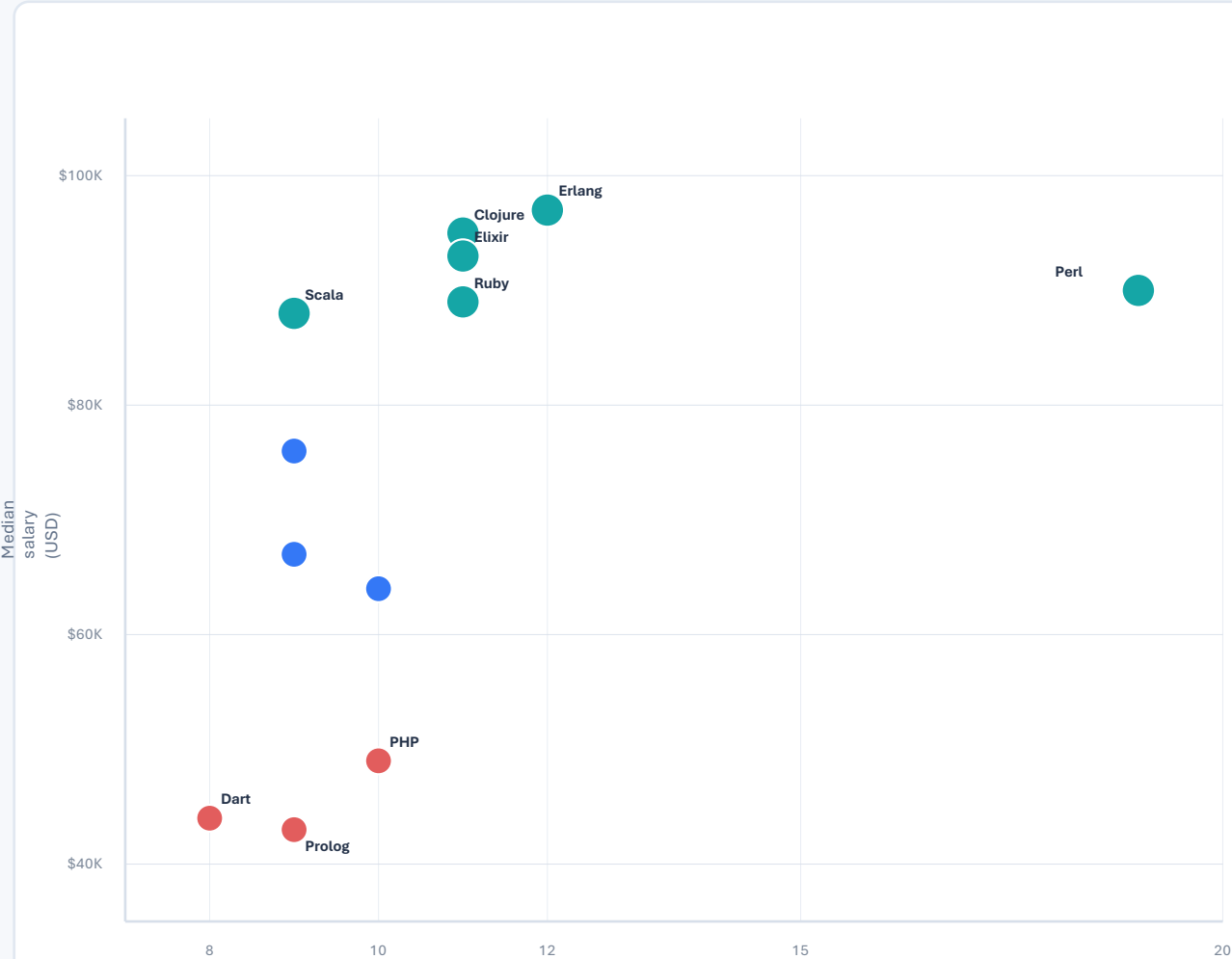


Compensation lens

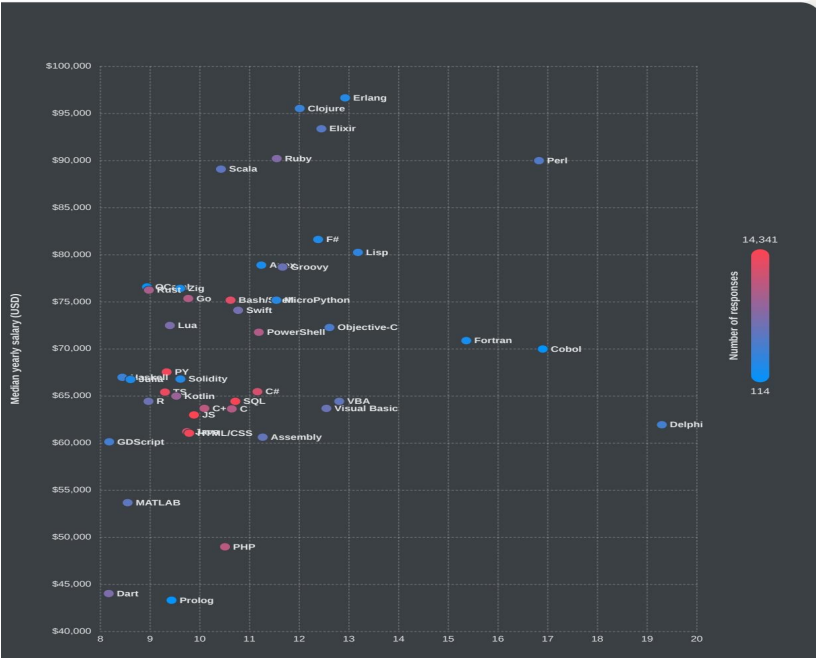
Leadership and DevRel: \$109K–\$127K medians, ~12–17 years experience.
Student outlier: \$15K median and ~2 years experience.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. average years of experience by programming language



Range fell roughly \$10K vs. 2023: now \$60–75K vs. \$70–85K last year years of language experience



Reference image: figure_3.jpg — language salary vs. experience

Language benchmarks

Niche functional languages correlate with higher medians: Erlang (~\$97K), Clojure (~\$95K), and Elixir (~\$93K).

Lowest listed medians: Dart (~\$44K), Prolog (~\$43K), and PHP (~\$49K).

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company-size context and technology purchasing influence

Company-size distribution



42,827 respondents; 47% work for organizations with fewer than 100 employees.

62%

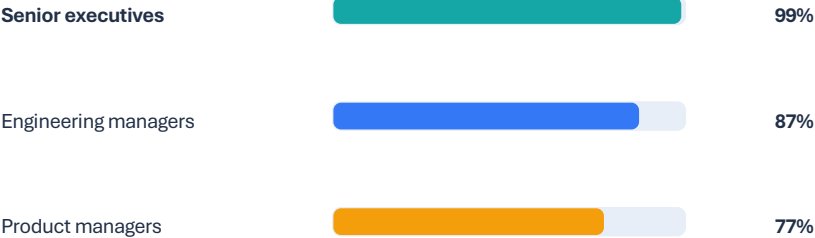
influence tech purchases

60%

prefer build-and-buy

Developers are not just end users; a majority have buying influence inside their organizations.

Who shapes purchasing?



Evaluation channels: free trials (75%) and asking other developers (73%).

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

01

Plan for flexible capacity

U.S. full-time employment fell from 69% to 64.8%; freelancing and contracting remain significant at 16%+.

02

Treat hybrid as the baseline

In-person work is creeping back to 20%, but hybrid remains the most common arrangement at 42%.

03

Budget for premium roles

DevRel, SRE, cloud infrastructure, and leadership roles command the highest medians in the benchmark set.

04

Use language mix as a pay signal

Niche functional languages such as Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir correlate with >\$93K medians.

05

Engage developer influencers

62% influence tech purchases; free trials and peer recommendations are core evaluation paths.